



Interface Design

IDE2IL

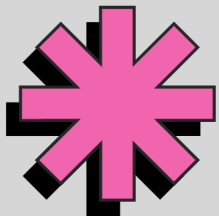


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TODAY'S GOAL

**DISCOVER HOW THIS COURSE WILL
EMPOWER YOU TO **THINK LIKE A DESIGNER**
TO CREATE STUNNING AND INTUITIVE
INTERFACES. GET READY TO EXPLORE THE
WORLD OF INTERFACE DESIGN!**





What?

Goals of this course

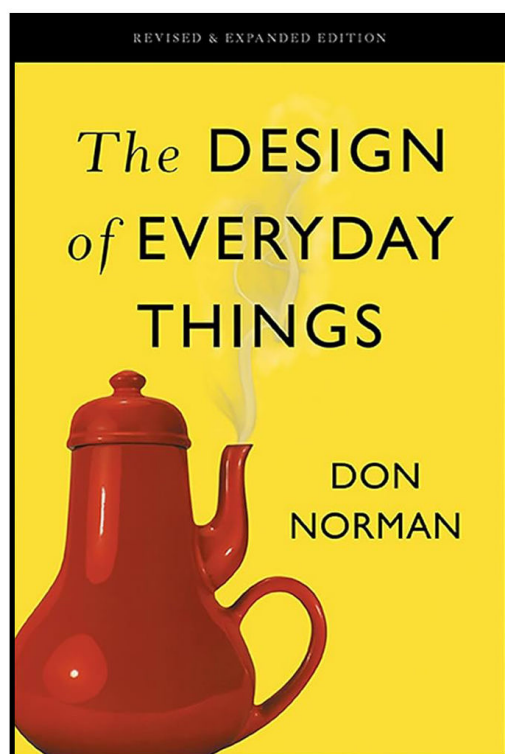
The Norman Door



We are not gonna
talk about doors,
but about DESIGN



discovering usability
flaws, problem
solving mindset



www.youtube.com/watch?v=9BdtGjoIN4E



discoverability
feedback

CLICK



We are gonna talk
about HOW TO DESIGN
digital interfaces



coming up with creative
solutions, applying
fundamental design principles



www.youtube.com/watch?v=9BdtGjoIN4E

#coffeemachine

#selfcheckoutkiosk

#app

#smartglass

#game

#laptop



#fitnesstracker

#vrheadset

AN INTERFACE

**IS ANY POINT WHERE A HUMAN
AND A MACHINE MEET.**

#atm

#website

#ticketmachine

#website

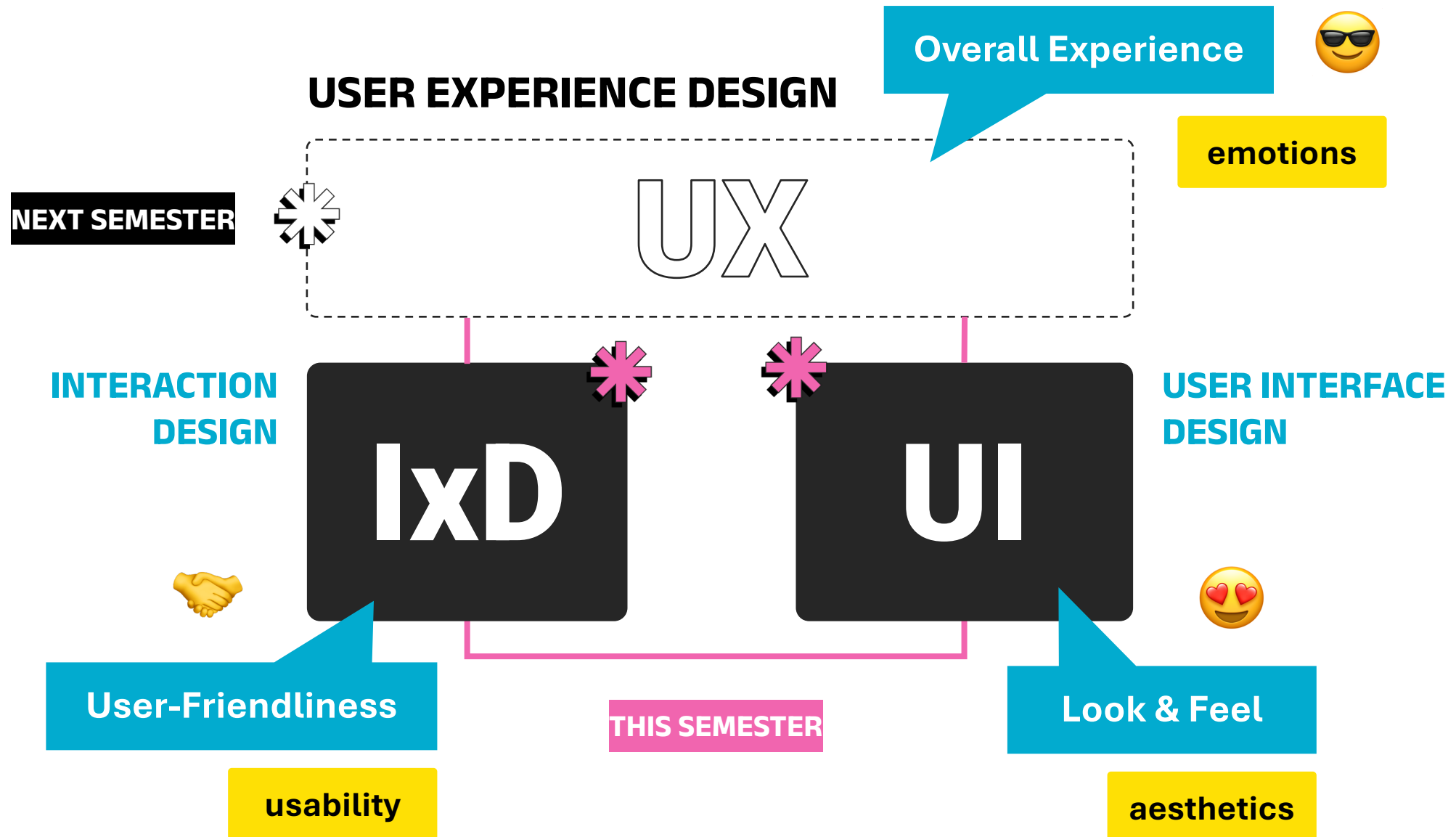
#cardashboard

#smartphone

#chatbot

#camera

#smarttv





Who?

Let's introduce ourselves

THE VDE TEAM

Kathrin Probst

Professor Human-Computer Interaction
Digital Media Department

5 sessions

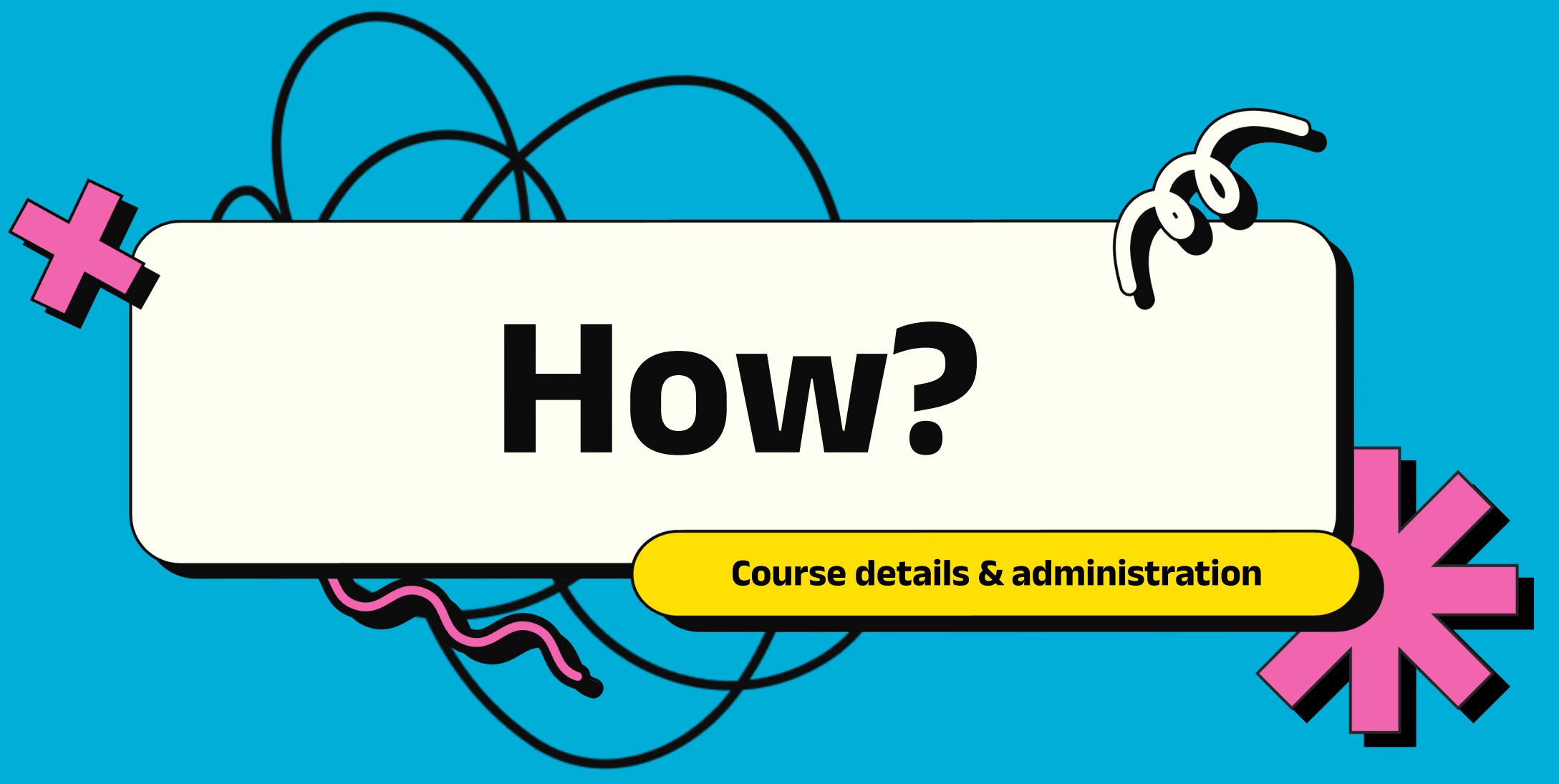
Focus: Usability

Lisa-Maria Freller

UX/UI Designer & Frontend Developer
Inola GmbH

4 sessions

Focus: Design



How?

Course details & administration

#1 CONTENT

TWO MAIN PARTS

DIRECTLY FEEDING INTO EACH OTHER.



IDE1IL Pt. 1

- Interface Worlds
- Interface Form Factors
- Usability Heuristics

5 sessions in 2 groups

IDE1IL Pt. 2

- Interface Design (Figma)
- Design Patterns
- Design Systems
- Responsive Design

4 sessions in 1 group



#2 EVALUATION

EVALUATION BASED ON **HANDS-ON** ACTIVITIES AND EXERCISES.



Visibility of
System Status



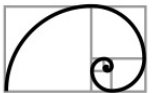
30% participation

- presence
- participation in-class activities
- in case you cannot join
 - > provide confirmation (e.g., doctor)
 - > inform your team members

70% challenges

- 5 design challenges
- mostly teamwork (teams of 2)
 - > every team member is expected to contribute equally
- visual communication

any personal concerns or special needs => let us know



Aesthetic And
Minimalistic Design



USING AI THOUGHTFULLY HELPS US WORK FASTER, SMARTER, WITH GREATER IMPACT.

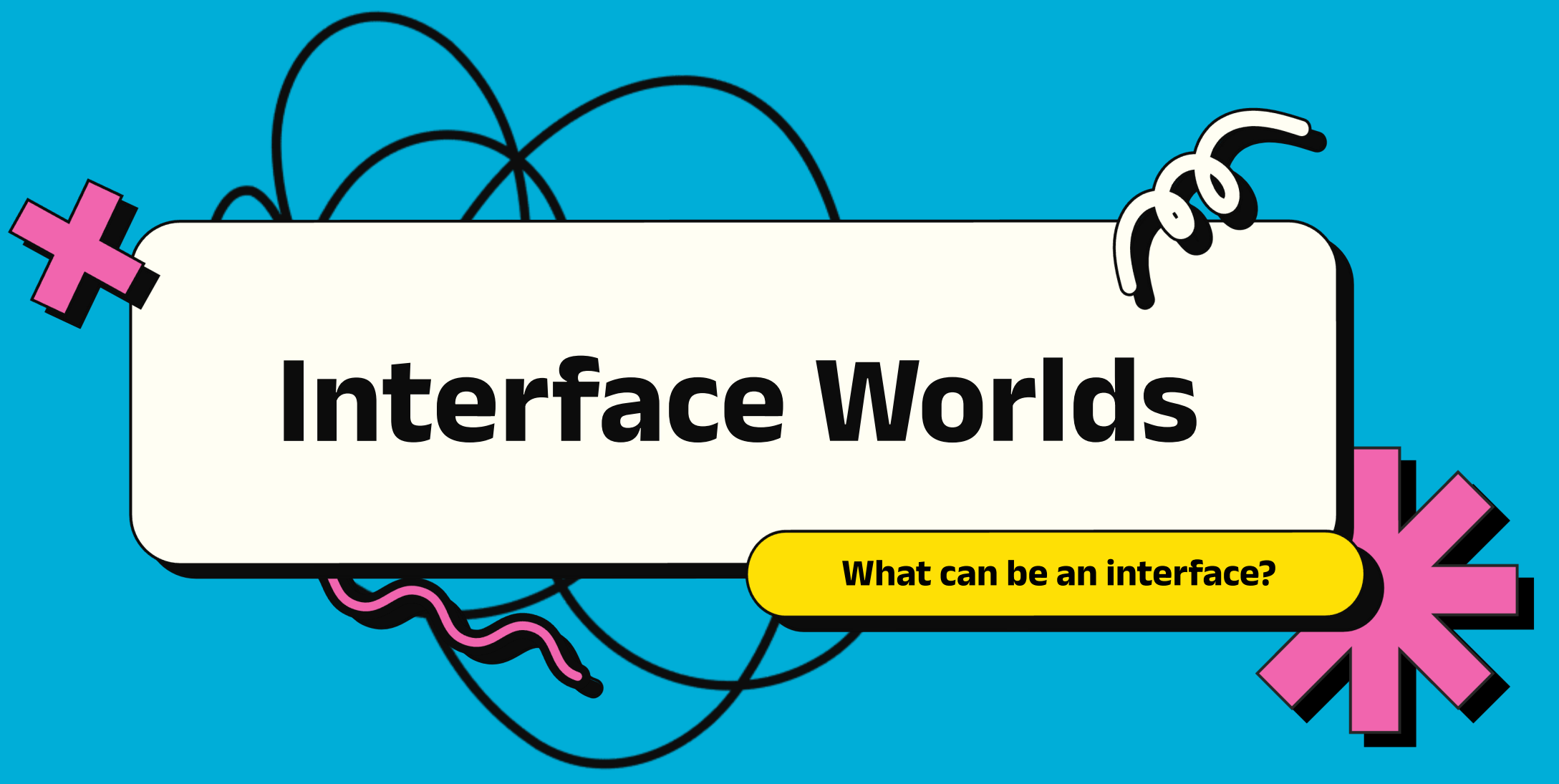
Will AI replace me as a designer?

- AI is a tool, not a designer. It can generate pixels, but cannot understand intent, context, or human frustration.
- This course isn't about drawing buttons, it's about Systemic Thinking and Usability (which AI still struggles with).
- **You are not learning to compete with AI, you are learning to direct it**

- AI tools may be used unless stated otherwise
- usage to be communicated in a transparent way (e.g., chat history, iterations)
- we will share examples & recommendations based on state-of-the-art design practice

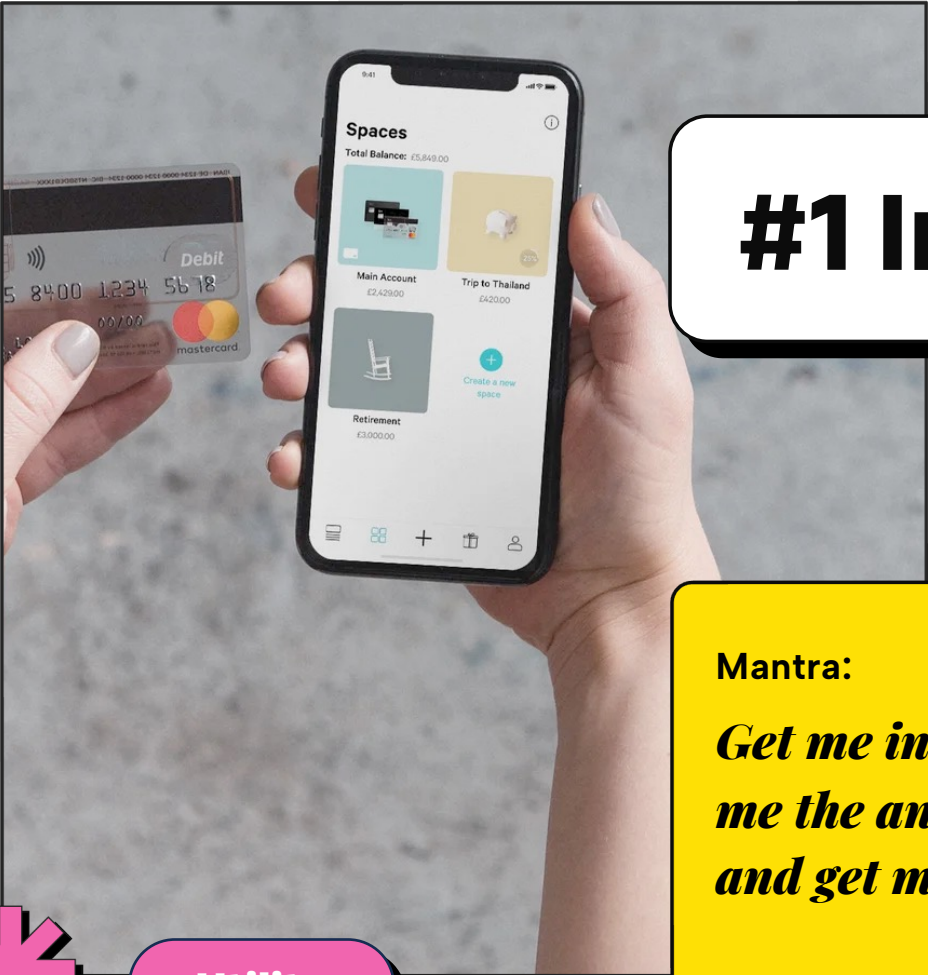
AI literacy can be your competitive edge on the job market





Interface Worlds

What can be an interface?



#1 Information & Service

The Foundation

- **User Intent:** **Goal-oriented retrieval or transaction.**
Users have a specific, pre-existing intent and want to spend the minimum amount of time required.
- **Examples:** banking, booking appointment or tickets, checking the weather...

Mantra:

*Get me in, get
me the answer,
and get me out*



Utility

#1 Information & Service

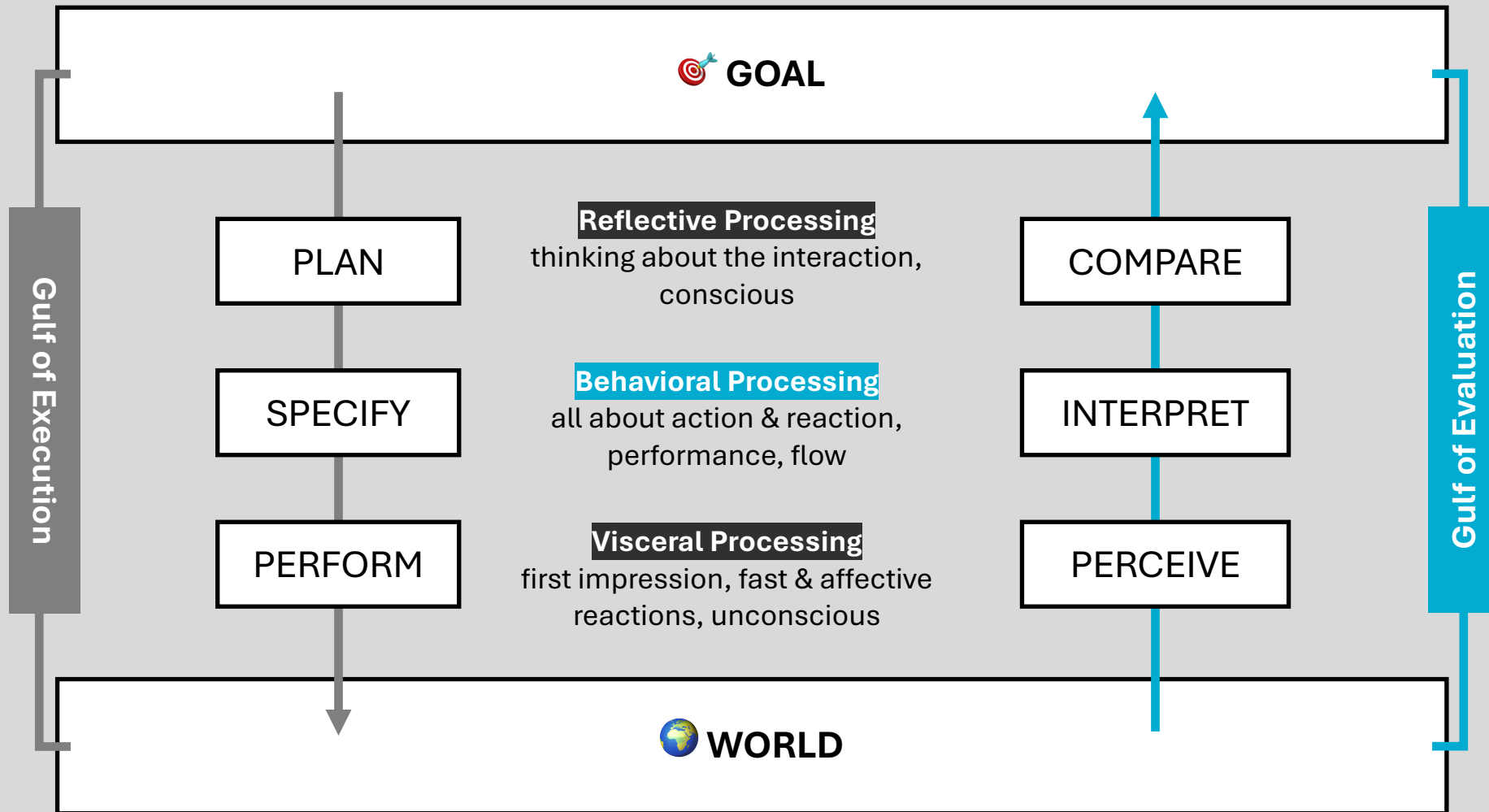
The Foundation

Mantra:

*Get me in, get
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and get me out*

Utility

- **Theory: Bridging the Gulf of Evaluation**
The interface must provide explicit feedback, so the user doesn't have to guess the system's state.
- **Theory: Reduce Cognitive Load**
The interface should act as a transparent bridge to a result. The goal is to reduce the cognitive load of a task so it can be completed and forgotten.
- **Theory: Behavioral Level Efficiency**
Users' brains are focused on functional performance, the interface should feel efficient.





#2 Consumption & Lifestyle

The Distraction

- **User Intent:** **Frictionless discovery.**
Users do not have a defined goal, they want the interface to guide them down a path of least resistance.
- **Examples:** short-form video feeds, movie/music streaming services, social media stories...

Mantra:

***Keep me
scrolling and
show me
something I love***



Dopamine



#2 Consumption & Lifestyle

The Distraction

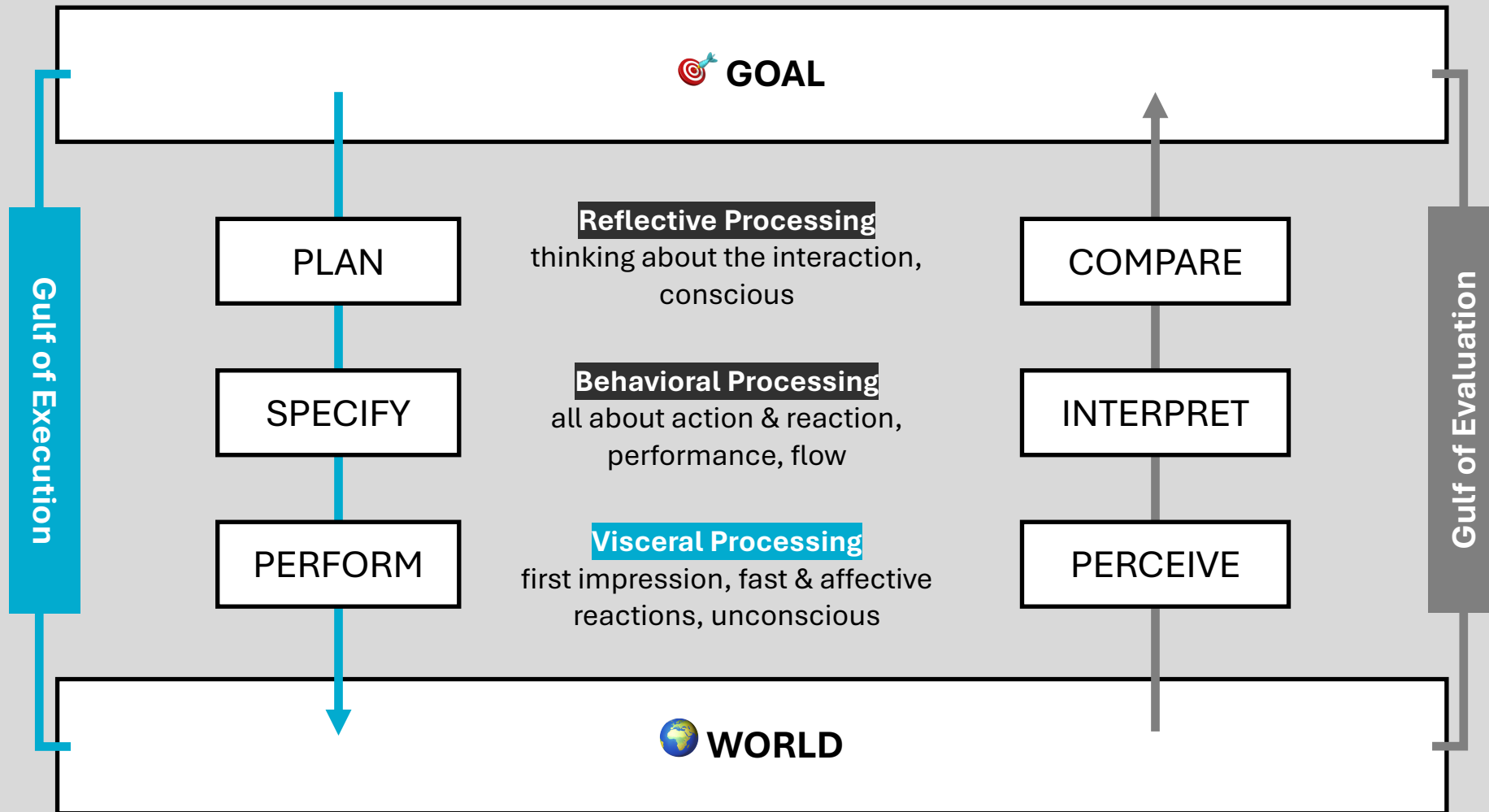
Mantra:

*Keep me
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something I love*



Dopamine

- **Theory: Bridging the Gulf of Execution**
Reducing the gap between the user's desire to be entertained and the actions required to get there.
- **Theory: Content-First**
The interface recedes into the background, the presentation of the content takes center stage. **Frictionless design** should reduce cognitive load.
- **Theory: Visceral Level Processing**
Focus on the aesthetic, motion, and vibe before users even think or act.





#3 Creation & Operation

The Extension

- **User Intent:** **Sustained attention.**
Users are actively working, building, or monitoring, and require deep focus without having their concentration broken.
- **Examples:** design / editing tools, spreadsheets, car dashboards, hospital vitals monitors...

Mantra:

Give me all the tools so I can stay in the flow



Pro



#3 Creation & Operation

The Extension

Mantra:

*Give me all the
tools so I can
stay in the flow*



- **Theory: Bridging the Gulf of Execution**

To help users figure out *how* to achieve their complex goals, tools and commands should be available quickly to avoid breaking user **flow**.

- **Theory: Automated Operation**

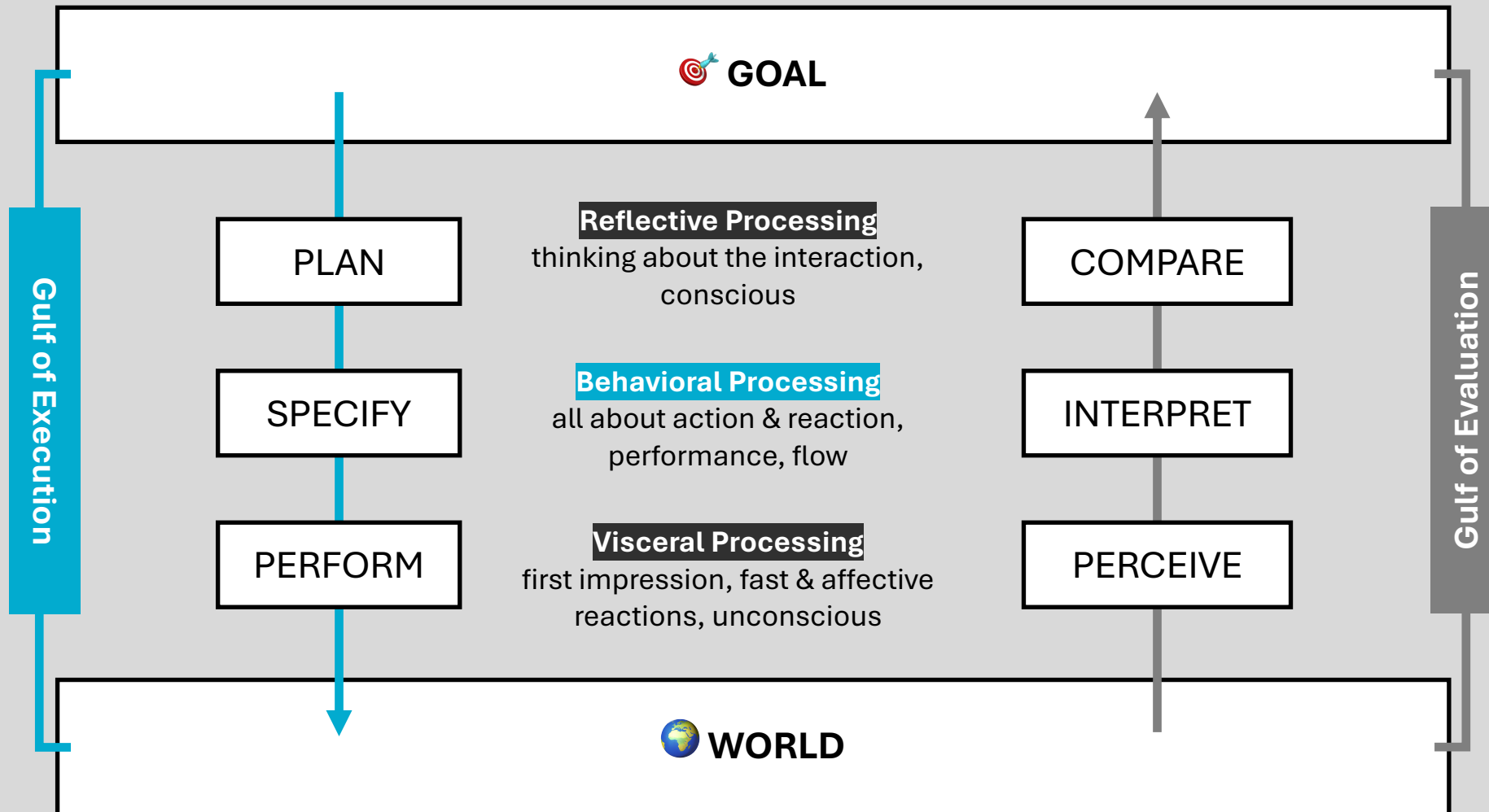
By putting tools on the surface, the goal is to move from a conscious action to automated operation.

- **Theory: Behavioral Level Mastery**

Users want to reach a state where the interface disappears, and their brain operates the software like a physical limb.



Pro





#4 Play & Immersion

The Alternate Reality

- **User Intent:** **Emotional presence and investment.**
Users step inside a digital environment where the interaction itself is the desired activity, not just a means to an end.
- **Examples:** RPG game, shooters, simulators, mobile games, gamified learning...

Mantra:

***Make the
interface part
of the
adventure***



Narrative





#4 Play & Immersion

The Alternate Reality

Mantra:

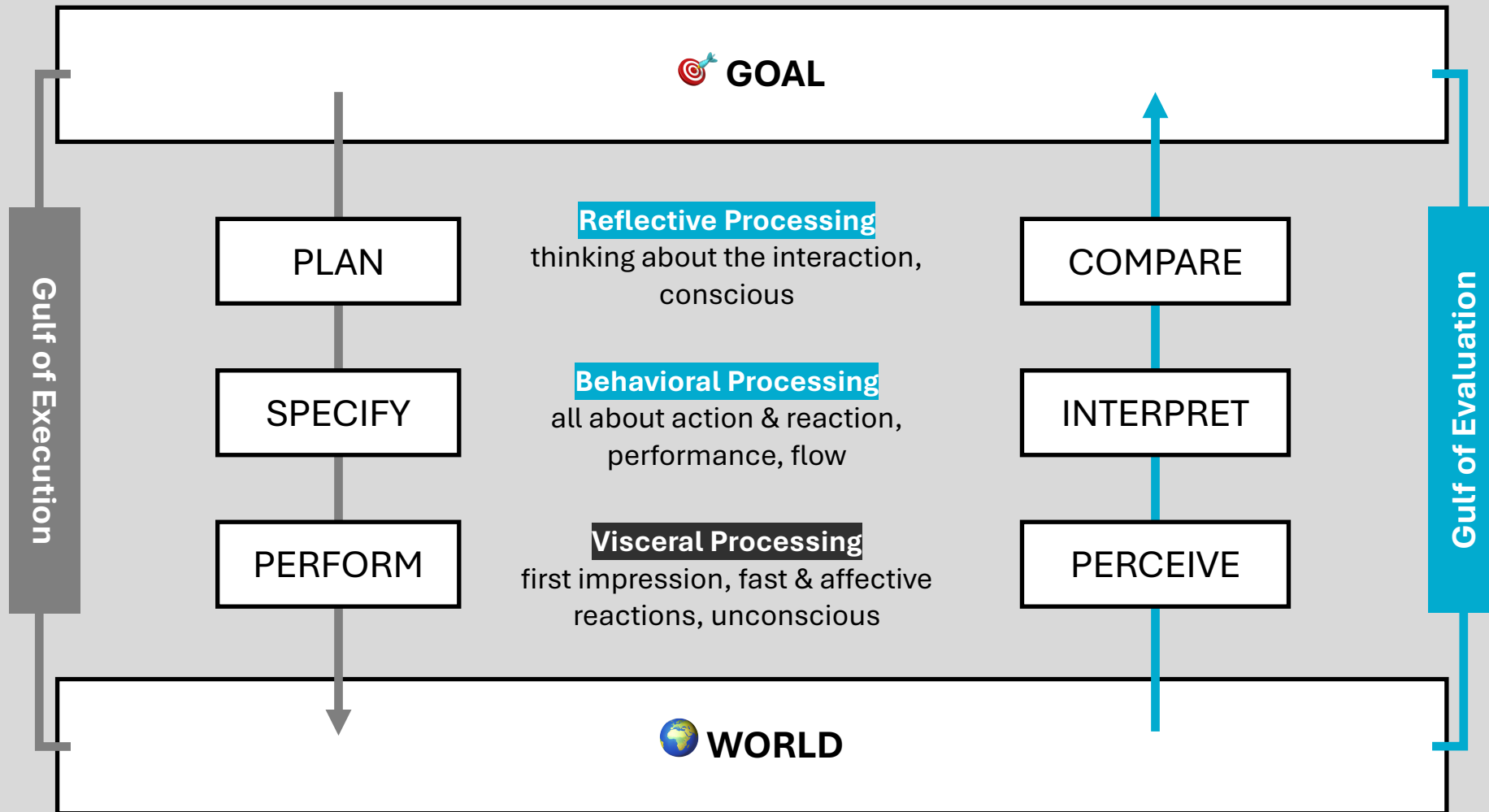
***Make the
interface part
of the
adventure***



Narrative



- **Theory: Bridging the Gulf of Evaluation**
Interfaces should provide rich immediate feedback (visual, audio, or haptic) to support immersion.
- **Theory: Diegetic vs. Non-Diegetic**
Operating within the boundary where the rules of the real world end and the game begins: non-diegetic outside the game world (e.g., inventory), diegetic interface inside the game world (e.g., health indicator).
- **Theory: Visceral + Reflective Level Processing**
The visceral level provides the thrill, while the reflective level connects the interface to users' player identity.





#5 Assistance & Intelligence

The Future

- **User Intent:** **Delegation and collaboration.**
Users are no longer issuing rigid commands, they are interpreting and negotiating an outcome with a system that generates dynamic responses.
- **Examples:** chatbots, AI assistants, image generation, autonomous systems...

Mantra:

***Don't just show
me options,
help me solve
the problem***



Conversational



#5 Assistance & Intelligence

The Future

Mantra:

*Don't just show
me options,
help me solve
the problem*

Conversational

- **Theory: Bridging the Gulf of Evaluation**

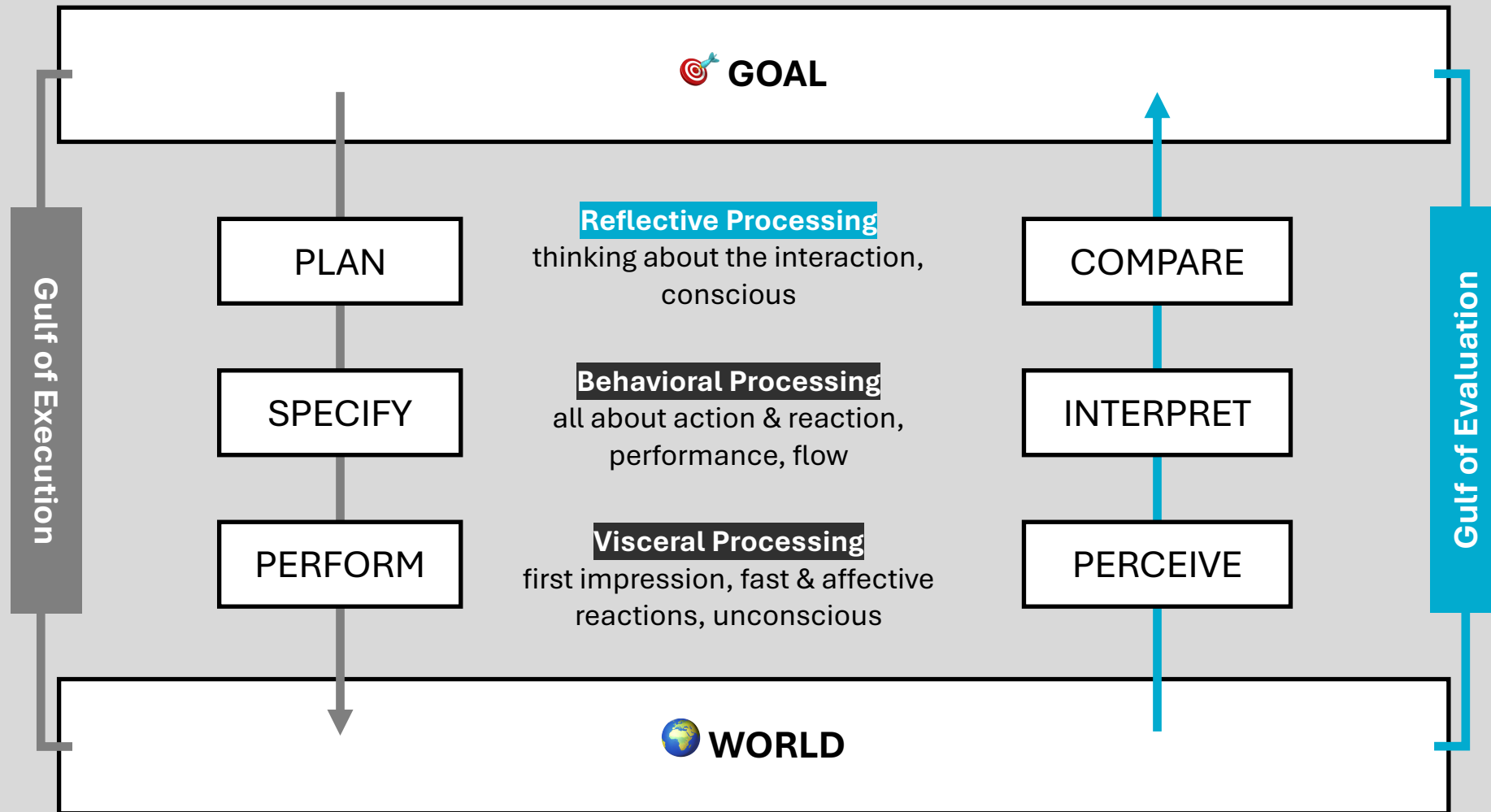
Because AI is generative, the system's state is constantly changing, and the user doesn't know how it arrives at an answer. The interface must provide **transparency** to build trust.

- **Theory: Human-Machine Symbiosis**

The machine becomes a partner in the activity as the user delegates the action and focuses on the motive.

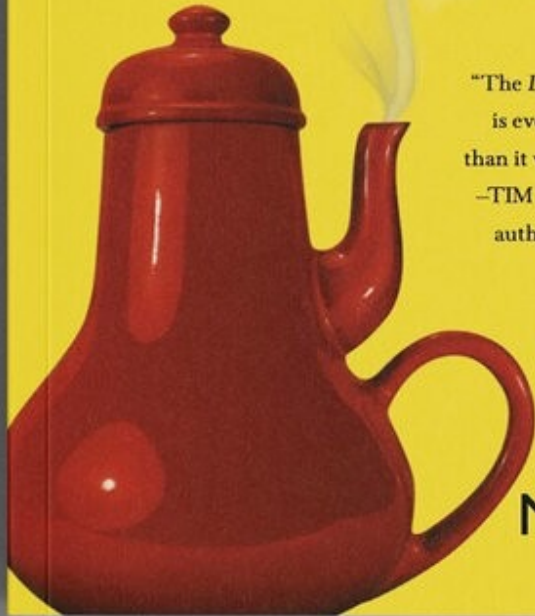
- **Theory: Reflective Level Processing**

Interfaces should support users in reflecting on the quality and logic of the AI's response.



REVISED & EXPANDED EDITION

The DESIGN of EVERYDAY THINGS

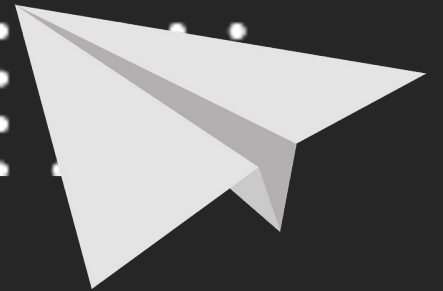


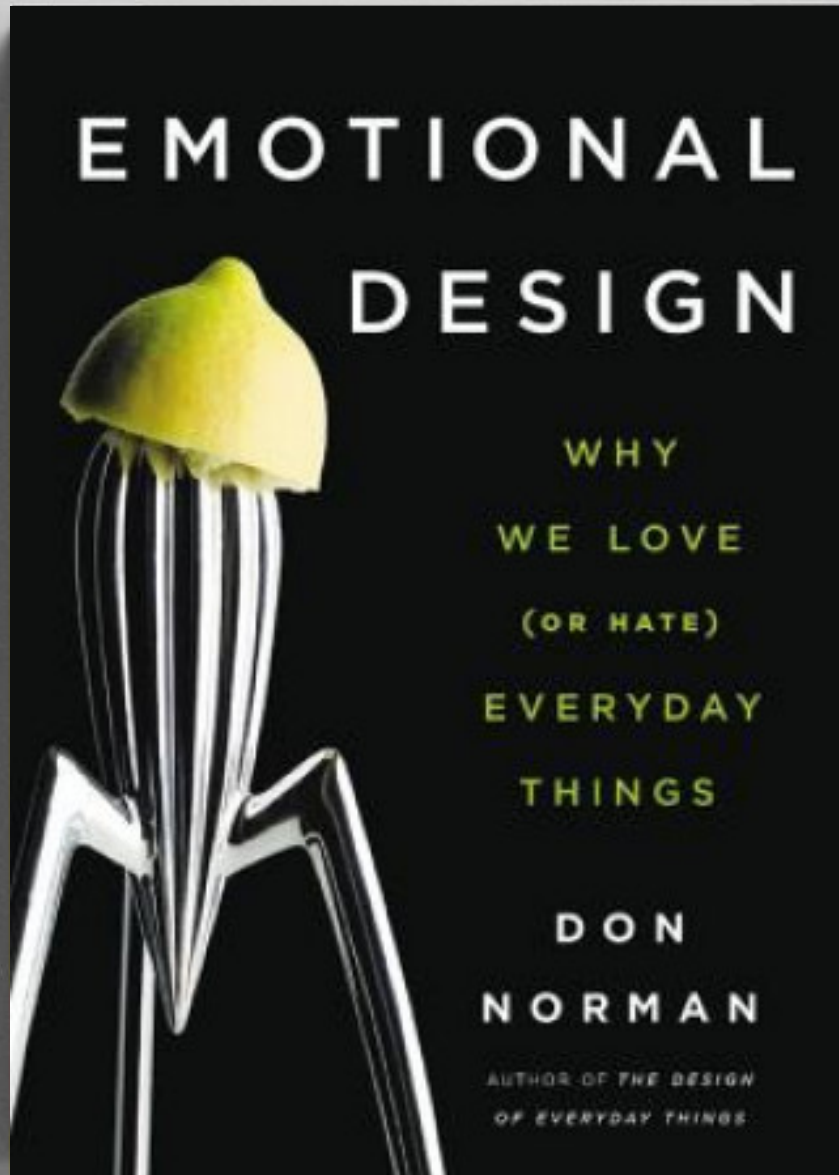
"The *Design of Everyday Things*
is even more relevant today
than it was when first published."
—TIM BROWN, CEO of IDEO,
author of *Change by Design*

DON
NORMAN

PUT ON YOUR

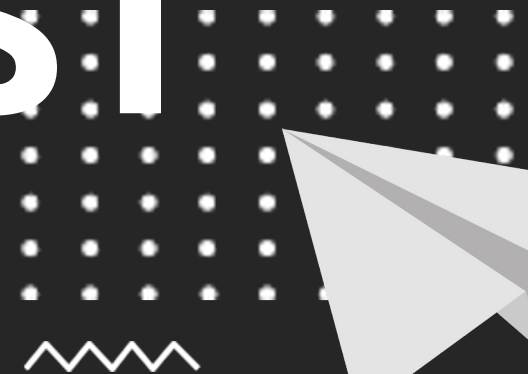
READING LIST





PUT ON YOUR

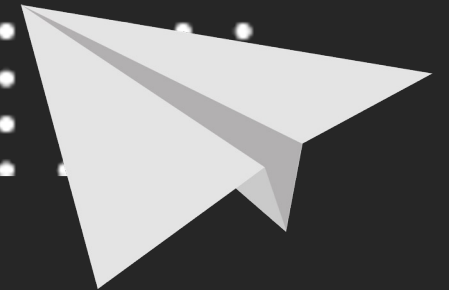
READING LIST





PUT ON YOUR

READING LIST





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IDE2IL

up next: IDE2IL 10.03.



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